



**WORLD
WILDLIFE DAY**
3 MARCH

Organized by:



World Wildlife Day 2026 Official Poster Contest Guidelines

Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods

1. Contest Theme

The theme of World Wildlife Day 2026 (WWD2026) is **"Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods."** The conservation of medicinal and aromatic plants (MAPs) is vital, as they form the foundation of many healthcare systems, support diverse industries and play a crucial role in sustaining ecosystems. WWD2026 celebrates the creative conservation efforts surrounding MAPs and aims to foster ongoing research, innovation, and partnerships for their sustainable use. The 2026 Official Poster Contest invites graphic designers to create posters that align with and spread awareness on this theme.

For information on the #WWD2026 theme, please see the [WWD2026 Concept Note](#).

For accessing previous World Wildlife Day posters, please see the [World Wildlife Day Flickr Gallery](#).

2. Eligibility

The contest is open to all individuals worldwide who are passionate about wildlife and graphic design. The contest winner should be prepared to assist between 24 November 2025 and 19 December 2025 in adapting the poster for additional uses and dimensions (e.g., virtual background, YouTube banner, etc.).

3. Submission Requirements

- **Poster Specifications:**
 - Posters must be original digital work created by the participant using Adobe Illustrator, Canva or other similar graphic design/illustration software.
 - Posters must not be AI-generated
 - Acceptable formats: JPEG, PNG, or PDF
 - Please submit two high-resolution versions of the poster with the following aspect ratios:
 - Instagram post: 4:5
 - Facebook post: 16:9

**Please note: the winner will be invited to adapt the high-resolution poster for additional uses (email signatures, virtual backgrounds, etc.)*

- **Submission Method:**
 - Posters must be submitted via email (wildlifeday@un.org), as attachments, via [WeTransfer](#), etc.
 - Each participant may submit multiple entries.

- Each participant must include the following information with their poster submission:
 - Full name
 - Title (Mr/Ms), or pronouns
 - Nationality
 - Occupation
 - Brief bio: introduce yourself in 1-2 sentences
 - Brief summary of the poster: introduce the poster in 1-2 sentences

4. Important Dates

- **Contest launch:** 1 October 2025
- **Submission deadline:** 2 November 2025, 23:59 CET
- **Winner announcement:** 21 November 2025
- **Poster adaptation period:** 24 November to 19 December 2025
- **Publication of all poster versions:** Early January 2026
- **World Wildlife Day 2026:** 3 March 2026

5. Judging Criteria

A panel of experts within the CITES Secretariat, United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Jackson Wild and ifaw will review the posters and select the winner based on the following judging criteria:

- **Relevance to theme:** How well does the poster reflect the WWD2026 theme?
- **Creativity and originality:** Is the poster unique, innovative and original (e.g., not AI-generated)?
- **Visual appeal:** Is the design aesthetically pleasing and technically well-executed?
- **Overall impact:** Does the poster inspire action or raise awareness about medicinal and aromatic plants?

6. Participation Perks

- A certificate of recognition by the Secretariat of the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES)
- Global visibility across Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook, YouTube, Flickr and the United Nations platforms

7. Intellectual Property Rights

- By submitting a poster, participants grant World Wildlife Day 2026 event organizers the right to use, reproduce, and distribute the poster in any media, for non-commercial, promotional and educational purposes.
- Participants retain the copyright to their original work.

8. Privacy

- Contact information collected during the contest will be used solely for the purposes of administering the contest and will not be shared with third parties.
- Personal information about the winner collected with the consent of the winner will be used solely for the purposes of promoting the winner and the poster.

9. Contact Information

- For any questions or technical issues, please contact wildlifeday@un.org.